

PROJECT CONFLUENCE

Journal Design Specification

Canonical Visual Grammar for the Voyagewright Developer Journal Family



Design contract

The design is invariant. The composition is free. Every weekly journal must look like a member of the same publication family established by the 37-page expanded edition of *The Compass Points Home*, while no weekly title, thesis, section structure, opening, ending, or page count is prewritten.

This document freezes the exact reusable page geometry, typography roles, color system, running matter, spacing rhythm, borders, table language, pull-quote behavior, figure treatment, and rendering rules for Project Confluence. It does not provide a reusable journal outline or any reusable prose.

Version 1.0 • August 17, 2026

Canonical precedent: The Compass Points Home, Expanded Edition (37 pages)

1. Document Control

C1 - Set the Type

Field	Value
Program	Project Confluence
Document	Journal Design Specification
Version	1.0
Date	August 17, 2026
Status	Canonical C1 design baseline
Governing parent	Project Confluence Governing Document v1.0
Canonical visual precedent	Voyagewright Developer Journal - The Compass Points Home, Expanded Edition (37 pages)
Applies to	Private master journals and publish-safe public derivatives
Core rule	One invariant visual grammar; zero prewritten weekly narrative structure

Design authority

This specification is the implementation authority for journal appearance. The 37-page reference remains the artistic precedent; this specification converts its implicit visual language into explicit reusable tokens and component rules. A later weekly journal may flow differently, but changing the tokens below requires a versioned Project Confluence design amendment rather than ad hoc weekly experimentation.

Not a template

This specification may define where a running header lives, how much space follows a section title, how tables are drawn, and which colors and fonts are canonical. It may not define what a future section is called, how many sections exist, what the first sentence says, or what the week is supposed to mean.

2. Design Philosophy

Identical visual grammar, original composition

The journal family should be immediately recognizable before the reader has processed a single sentence. Identity comes from recurring geometry, typography, color, running matter, rules, separators, tables, white-space rhythm, and editorial restraint. Weekly originality comes from the evidence-derived title, structure, pacing, emphasis, and prose.

Invariant every week	Free every week
A4 page geometry and fixed margins	Total page count
Font families and role hierarchy	Whether a contents page exists
Teal / gold / cream / gray palette	Title and subtitle wording
Running header/footer positions	Section count and names
Gold diamond separator language	Chronology and narrative architecture
Paragraph and heading spacing rhythm	Whether figures/tables/appendices are useful
Table, note, caption, pull-quote styling	Balance of technical detail and personal reflection
Page numbering and privacy/date line	Where natural page breaks occur

Visual invariance test

If two weekly journals are shown side by side with their words blurred, they should still look like the same publication. If their prose is extracted without formatting, they should not read as though the same outline was filled in twice.

3. Page Geometry and Editorial Grid

The fixed physical frame

The 37-page precedent uses a tall, airy editorial page with very wide usable measure, restrained running matter at the edges, and deliberate white-space around major section openings. Project Confluence standardizes that frame as follows.

Token	Canonical value	Rule
Page size	A4 portrait - 210 x 297 mm	All journals use A4 unless a future design amendment explicitly changes the publication format.
Left / right page margins	6 mm	Wide text measure is intentional and matches the precedent. Tables and full-width editorial bands may use the full body width.
Top page margin	6 mm	Reserved for running header plus white-space. Body content does not collide with running matter.
Bottom page margin	6 mm	Reserved for date/privacy line and page number.
Running header zone	4.5-11 mm from top edge	Centered; always outside body flow.
Running footer zone	4.5-11 mm from bottom edge	Date/privacy left; page number right.
Primary body measure	198 mm maximum	Normal prose may use the full editorial measure; pull quotes are narrower.
Section-opening content start	~60 mm from top edge on a clean page	Provides the same generous diamond-title-subtitle-diamond rhythm as the precedent.
Continuation page start	~18-22 mm below top edge	Continuation pages begin promptly beneath the running header.
Minimum bottom clear zone	14 mm	Do not allow body text or table rules to crowd the footer.

Page-break behavior

- Major evidence-derived sections prefer a clean-page start when doing so improves narrative pacing; they are not forced to start on a new page when the preceding section naturally yields enough space for a complete section opener.
- Do not leave a section title, subtitle, or gold separator stranded at the bottom of a page. Keep the opener with at least the first paragraph.
- Avoid widows and orphans in long-form prose. Prefer moving 2-3 lines rather than compressing spacing to rescue one line.
- Never shrink body type to force a target page count. Page count is content-derived.

4. Typography System

Serif narrative, sans-serif navigation

The precedent combines a literary serif body with a strong modern sans-serif display face. The contrast is part of the publication identity: narrative remains warm and book-like, while structural headings remain crisp and navigable.

Role	Canonical type	Size / weight	Color	Usage
Body prose	Georgia (fallback: Times New Roman / Noto Serif)	10.5 pt regular	#222222	Primary long-form narrative.
Body emphasis	Georgia	10.5 pt bold	#222222	Short inline emphasis only.
Pull quote	Georgia	15.5 pt semibold / bold	#173F4C	Centered, narrow measure, no quotation marks unless the source itself is quoted.
Section title	Arial (fallback: Helvetica / Noto Sans)	24 pt bold	#173F4C	Centered on clean section openers; may scale to 21 pt for unusually long titles.
Section subtitle	Georgia	12.5 pt italic	#6F5146	Centered directly below section title.
Subheading	Arial	12 pt bold	#173F4C	Left aligned inside a section.
Small label	Arial	8.5 pt bold uppercase	#7A7D80	Journal entry labels, canon/source labels, compact metadata.
Running header	Georgia	8.5 pt bold uppercase	#7A7D80	Centered publication title and current journal title.
Footer / page number	Georgia	8.5 pt regular	#7A7D80	Date/privacy line and page number.
Table header	Georgia	9.5 pt bold	#FFFFFF	Deep-teal fill.
Table body	Georgia	9.5 pt regular	#222222	Alternating cream editorial bands.
Source note / caption	Georgia	8.7 pt italic	#7A7D80	Figures, snapshot notes, provenance annotations.

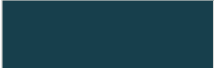
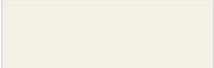
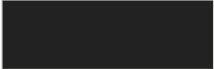
Body rhythm

Property	Value
Body line spacing	1.10-1.13 x font size
Paragraph spacing after	5 pt
Paragraph first-line indent	0 - paragraph separation is by white-space, not indent
Section opener title -> subtitle	6-8 pt
Subtitle -> lower diamond	10-12 pt
Lower diamond -> body	10-14 pt
Subheading before / after	9 pt / 4 pt
Pull quote top / bottom	12-16 pt / 12-16 pt

5. Color System and Decorative Language

Restrained maritime editorial identity

Color is sparse and functional. Teal establishes structure, gold marks ceremony and transitions, cream softens editorial data, warm brown supports reflective subtitles, and gray keeps running matter visually subordinate.

	Deep Teal	#173F4C - Primary section titles, table headers, dominant rules.
	Harbor Teal	#2E7D7B - Secondary headings, quiet accents, occasional dividers.
	Warm Gold	#C39A45 - Diamond separators, list bullets, ceremonial accents only.
	Editorial Cream	#F4F0E5 - Alternating table bands, rare callout backgrounds.
	Warm Brown	#6F5146 - Italic subtitles and reflective secondary text.
	Running Gray	#7A7D80 - Running header/footer, captions, source notes.
	Body Ink	#222222 - Primary prose.

Gold diamond rule

The gold diamond is the publication's recurring ceremonial mark. It should feel deliberate rather than decorative confetti. It is used above major section titles, below major section subtitles, between meaningful cover elements, and at the start of provenance/appendix closure moments when appropriate.

- Canonical glyph: ◆
- Canonical color: Warm Gold #C39A45
- Typical size: 10-12 pt in section openers; 14-18 pt on cover/title pages.
- Never use multiple diamonds as a generic bullet list. Ordinary bullets use a smaller gold dot/bullet language.

6. Running Matter and Page Anatomy

The publication stays recognizable while the story moves

Running header

Every interior page carries a centered, quiet header in gray serif capitals. Its canonical form is "DEVELOPER JOURNAL | <JOURNAL TITLE>". The journal title is evidence-derived and may be shortened only if the full title physically cannot fit at the canonical size. No project status, week number, or phase boilerplate is inserted unless that week's title itself requires it.

Footer

The lower-left footer carries the covered date or period plus the privacy/publication designation, separated by a centered bullet. The lower-right footer carries "Page N". For a private master, the designation is "Private project journal". A publish-safe derivative may use "Voyagewright developer journal" or another approved public label defined by publication policy.

Page element	Placement	Rule
Header	Centered in top running zone	Serif, gray, uppercase, publication + journal title.
Upper diamond	Centered below header on major section openers	Warm gold; omitted on continuation pages.
Major title	Centered	Deep teal sans; title wording comes only from the evidence.
Subtitle	Centered below title	Warm-brown serif italic; optional when a subtitle is genuinely useful.
Lower diamond	Centered below subtitle	Warm gold; closes opener ceremony.

Page element	Placement	Rule
Body	Full editorial measure	Serif narrative prose.
Footer left	Bottom left	Date/period + privacy/publication label.
Footer right	Bottom right	Page N.

7. Cover and Opening Page

Fixed composition logic, original words

The cover must remain recognizably related to The Compass Points Home without forcing every week into the same textual structure. It is an editorial title page, not a marketing cover.

Component	Invariant design rule	Weekly freedom
Publication label	Small uppercase “DEVELOPER JOURNAL” in deep teal/sans near upper body area.	None - publication identity remains fixed.
Journal title	Largest text on page, deep teal sans, left aligned.	Entire title is discovered from the week.
Subtitle / deck	Warm-brown serif italic below title when useful.	Optional; entirely original.
Gold diamond	One ceremonial diamond separating title/deck from the central statement or metadata.	Position may move modestly with title length.
Thematic statement	Large centered or left-aligned serif statement with generous white-space.	Optional; must be authored from the week, never reused.
Date/time/location	Small gray/brown serif metadata.	May show exact authoring time or covered week depending on journal context.
Dedication / private note	Serif italic or regular, restrained.	Optional and evidence-derived.
Closing cover note	Small gray editorial note.	Optional; never a boilerplate sentence.

Cover non-template rule

The page may preserve the same typographic hierarchy and white-space logic while containing fewer or more textual elements than the precedent. Blank space is an active design element; do not fill it with invented boilerplate merely to match an old cover.

8. Section-Opening Grammar

A consistent ceremony for evidence-derived chapters

Major sections use the same visual ceremony as the precedent. The ceremony is fixed; the existence, number, names, order, and narrative role of the sections are not.

Sequence	Canonical behavior
1. Running header	Already present in page margin.
2. Upper gold diamond	Centered; creates a pause before the title.
3. Section title	Centered deep-teal sans, usually with section number when the journal uses numbered sections.
4. Section subtitle	Centered warm-brown serif italic; optional but encouraged when it clarifies the emotional/engineering angle.
5. Lower gold diamond	Centered; same size as upper mark.
6. Body start	Full-width serif prose after 10-14 pt breathing room.

Numbering policy

Section numbering is optional. When a journal uses numbered sections, numbers are part of the deep-teal title and follow the same display style. Appendices use capital letters. A journal may also intentionally use unnumbered sections if the narrative form benefits from it; the design identity does not depend on numbering.

9. Pull Quotes, Tables, Figures, and Editorial Evidence

Evidence should support the story, not hijack it

Pull quotes

Pull quotes are not decorative excerpts added every few pages. They are reserved for sentences that genuinely carry the section’s meaning. The precedent often uses them as hinge statements between technical detail and reflection.

- 15.5 pt serif semibold/bold, deep teal.
- Centered; maximum measure 120-135 mm, materially narrower than body text.
- No surrounding border or colored box by default.
- 12-16 pt white-space above and below.
- Avoid more than one strong pull quote per roughly two pages unless the material genuinely warrants it.

Tables

Tables use a factual editorial language that matches the August 15 project snapshot: deep-teal header row with white serif text, thin dark rules, and alternating cream/white body rows. Table data may be dense, but the table should still feel like part of the journal rather than an exported spreadsheet.

Table token	Canonical rule
Header fill	#173F4C
Header type	Georgia 9.5 pt bold, white
Body type	Georgia 9.5 pt regular, body ink
Alternating row fill	#F4F0E5 / white
Border	0.5 pt dark neutral rule
Cell padding	1.5-2.0 mm vertical; 2.0-2.5 mm horizontal
Alignment	Text left; numeric values may align left unless dense comparison benefits from right alignment
Source note	8.7 pt gray italic immediately below table

Figures and screenshots

- Use only when the image itself is historically meaningful or materially improves understanding.
- Maximum figure width is the body measure; preserve aspect ratio and avoid decorative crops that remove evidence.
- Caption uses 8.7 pt gray italic, centered or left-aligned consistently within the figure block.
- If a screenshot contains sensitive information, the private master may retain it only when policy allows; the public derivative must follow publish-safety redaction rules.

10. Contents, Appendices, and Provenance

Optional structure, fixed visual treatment when used

Contents page

A contents page is optional. It should exist only when the length and section count make it genuinely useful. When present, it follows the precedent: running header; upper diamond; centered deep-teal “Contents” heading; evidence-derived italic deck; lower diamond; then section rows with teal identifiers and alternating cream/white editorial bands.

Contents component	Rule
Heading	Centered, 24 pt deep-teal sans bold.
Deck	Centered, 12.5 pt warm-brown serif italic; entirely original.
Rows	Full body width; alternating cream/white.
Identifiers	Teal bold serif or sans, 10-11 pt.
Titles	Body serif 10.5-11 pt.
Appendices	Letter identifiers A, B, C... using same teal role.
Footer	Normal journal footer remains active.

Provenance appendix

The final journal should usually include a source/provenance appendix or equivalent closing record sufficient to explain what evidence streams supported it. This appendix is factual and may use lists, tables, and compact source notes. It does not need inline citation markers throughout the narrative.

End-of-entry page

The final page may end simply with “End of entry • <date or period>” in small gray serif text, as the precedent does. This is a design option rather than required weekly prose; the exact date/period is factual and the presence of an end marker may be omitted if the journal’s ending already resolves cleanly on the final page.

11. Accessibility, Rendering, and QA

A fixed visual grammar still has to survive actual documents

Requirement	Acceptance rule
Contrast	Deep teal, body ink and running gray must remain readable on white/cream; gold is never the sole carrier of meaning.
Heading structure	DOCX uses real heading styles/outline levels or semantically equivalent structure.
Tables	Header rows marked as headers and repeated on multi-page tables where possible.
Images	Meaningful figures receive alt text; decorative marks such as gold diamonds may be decorative.
Reading order	DOCX paragraph/table order follows visual order.
Widows/orphans	Avoid isolated single lines at page tops/bottoms where feasible.
DOCX render	Render every page to PNG and inspect at 100% before finalization.
PDF	Convert from validated DOCX, preflight, then render/inspect PDF.
Glyph safety	Use ordinary Unicode punctuation and verify all special glyphs, especially ♦.
No design drift	Compare weekly output against this specification, not merely against the prior week.

QA principle

The journal may be literary, but the output pipeline is not allowed to be romantic about clipping, missing glyphs, broken table rows, or footer collisions.

12. Canonical Design Tokens

Machine-readable values for C2-C7 implementation

The following tokens are frozen by Project Confluence C1. The implementation may encode them in JSON, YAML, TypeScript, Python, or another repository-standard representation, but changing a value changes the publication design and therefore requires a design-specification version bump.

Token	Value
page.format	A4 portrait
page.width_mm	210
page.height_mm	297
page.margin_left_mm	6
page.margin_right_mm	6
page.margin_top_mm	6
page.margin_bottom_mm	6
font.body_family	Georgia
font.display_family	Arial
font.body_pt	10.5
font.section_title_pt	24
font.section_subtitle_pt	12.5
font.pull_quote_pt	15.5
font.running_pt	8.5
font.table_pt	9.5
font.caption_pt	8.7
color.deep_tea	#173F4C
color.harbor_tea	#2E7D7B
color.warm_gold	#C39A45
color.editorial_cream	#F4F0E5
color.warm_brown	#6F5146
color.running_gray	#7A7D80
color.body_ink	#222222
glyph.section_separator	◆
body.line_spacing	1.11
body.paragraph_after_pt	5
pull_quote.max_width_mm	130
section.clean_page_body_start_mm	60
table.border_pt	0.5

13. Design Drift Boundaries

What weekly authors may and may not change

Allowed without design amendment	Requires a design amendment
Any evidence-derived title/subtitle	Changing page format or margins
Any evidence-derived section structure	Changing font families or canonical role hierarchy
Any evidence-derived page count	Changing core color tokens
Adding/removing a contents page based on usefulness	Moving running header/footer to different zones
Using/no using tables, figures, appendices	Replacing the diamond motif
Changing the number/placement of pull quotes based on story	Changing table language or border system
Choosing chronology, reverse chronology, braided structure, acts, questions, etc.	Changing body type size/leading as a weekly stylistic experiment
Using more or less white-space when content naturally requires it	Adding new recurring decorative systems not defined here

The weekly author has editorial freedom, not art-direction freedom

ChatGPT may reinvent the story every week. It may not reinvent the publication every week. If the week feels different, the document should express that difference through writing, pacing, section architecture, and evidence selection inside the same visual system.

14. C1 Completion and Downstream Contract

What this design specification gives the implementation

With this document, Project Confluence C1 - Set the Type - is complete as a design artifact. C2-C7 may now implement the archive, collectors, synthesis, master authoring, delivery, scheduling, and replay paths against one stable design authority.

Downstream implementation must create

- A repository-readable style token file equivalent to the values in Section 12.
- A journal rendering component/library that applies the tokens consistently to DOCX and PDF generation.
- Validation that compares generated documents against token rules and catches margin, font-role, color, running-matter, table, and page-number drift.
- A style reference in the private archive under references/ that contains these design rules but no reusable prose, title, thesis, section names, openings, or endings.
- A replay test proving that an evidence-derived journal can vary in length and structure while still matching the same design grammar.

Final rule

Same publication. Different week. Different story.

The visual system exists to make continuity visible. The writing exists to make the week itself visible. Project Confluence succeeds only when neither one is allowed to erase the other.

Appendix A. Reference Observations

What the 37-page precedent contributes

The design grammar above is derived from the expanded edition of The Compass Points Home. The reference repeatedly demonstrates the same core moves: a quiet centered running header; section openings framed by warm-gold diamonds; large deep-teal sans-serif titles; warm-brown italic decks; serif long-form prose; centered narrow pull quotes; full-width factual tables with deep-teal headers and alternating cream bands; and restrained gray footer/date treatment. The contents page and project-snapshot table demonstrate that structured information can coexist with the memoir voice without turning the document into a report.

The reference also proves that the design tolerates substantial variation in content density. Some pages are dense engineering narrative; others are reflective and spacious; some contain tables; others contain hinge statements or short endings. The invariant is not identical page composition. The invariant is the publication language surrounding that composition.

Appendix B. Machine Reference File

Recommended private-repository companion

The C2 implementation should place a text-only companion under references/journal-visual-style.md in the private archive. It should be generated from this specification and contain design tokens, component rules, accessibility requirements, and the absolute prohibition on reusable journal prose. A companion token file such as journal-design-tokens.json is also recommended for rendering code.

No prose in the machine style reference

The style reference may say “section title: 24 pt deep teal sans, centered.” It may not say “begin each journal with a section called What Actually Moved.” The rendering system gets design instructions; the author gets evidence.



End of specification • Project Confluence C1